THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Who were the 'sepoys'? 1

(a) Indian soldiers in the Company's army **(b)** planters
(c) British judges **(d)** tax collectors

2. The Doctrine of Lapse was disliked because 1

(a) it raised no taxes **(b)** it ignored adoption by rulers
(c) it increased salaries **(d)** it freed states

3. After 1857 the British adopted divide and rule to 1

(a) prevent unity among Indians **(b)** end taxes
(c) reduce army **(d)** unite Indians

4. Which was a long-term effect of drain of wealth? 1

(a) Fewer famines **(b)** Poverty of India **(c)** Prosperity **(d)** More industry

5. The 1770 famine was worsened by 1

(a) free grain **(b)** high revenue demanded in bad years
(c) no soldiers **(d)** heavy rains

6. Rani Lakshmibai fought the British because 1

(a) she loved Clive
(b) she wanted Delhi
(c) she was defeated
(d) Jhansi was annexed under the Doctrine of Lapse

7. The Sannyasi-Fakir rebellion began because 1

(a) railways **(b)** famine and heavy taxes caused distress
(c) Plassey **(d)** Macaulay

8. Grain exports during the 1876-78 famine 1

(a) reduced prices **(b)** worsened shortages
(c) solved hunger **(d)** helped farmers

9. Begum Hazrat Mahal led the revolt in 1

(a) Chennai **(b)** Goa **(c)** Pune **(d)** Lucknow (Awadh)

10. Which best describes the East India Company after 1757? 1

(a) A school
(b) A Mughal court
(c) A trading firm acting as a political power
(d) A temple

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why was the Battle of Colachel notable? 2

12. How did the British ruin Indian textiles? 2

13. What was the purpose of the Resident? 2

14. What changed in India's governance after 1858? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse causes of the Bengal famine of 1770. 3

16. Compare the Santhal Rebellion and the Indigo Revolt. 3

17. Explain why many rulers could not unite against the British. 3

OR

Why did the Great Famine of 1876-78 cause huge deaths? 3

18. Why were Vellore and Barrackpore warnings to the British? 3

OR

How did colonial policy affect the common person? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Describe the major causes of the 1857 rebellion. 5

OR

Discuss the legacy of colonial rule, both harmful and unintended. 5

20. Explain the course and the results of 1857. 5

OR

Explain why Indian rulers lost power: weaknesses and British strengths. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

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